



Reliance Android CDMA

Reliance launched the Coolpad D530 last month, India's first Android CDMA phone
<http://on-msn.com/qd3bdZ>

iPhone 5 is coming

Apple calls for a media event on October 4th. Tim Cook might unveil the device
<http://goo.gl/HApq0>

Bazaar

Reliance 3G Tab

The price single-handedly swings the deal, favourably!

The Reliance 3G Tab (essentially the ZTE V9C) changes the price dynamics of the tablet market quite dramatically. But will it really put pressure on other tablet manufacturers to slash their prices?

Look and design

The Reliance 3G Tab has minimalist looks. Quite simply, this is the most matter-of-fact tablet we've seen till date. The display has a glossy black frame bezel which attracts fingerprints. The build quality of the tablet overall is pretty acceptable, given the device's entry-level price point. There are no hardware buttons for home, menu and return – just touch-based ones. They don't light up in the dark, and that can be a little uncomfortable for frequent use.

The Reliance 3G Tab just feels very compact thanks to the seven-inch display. However, those of us who've used the very first Samsung Galaxy Tab, the P1000, would most probably agree that it felt much bigger than this one, and it was slightly thicker too. Weight-wise, the Reliance 3G Tab tips the scales at 389 grams.

Features

We expected the pricing to dictate the power game, in a negative way. However, an ARM11 800MHz processor along with 512 MB of RAM powers this tablet – not bad. While there's literally no internal storage space to boast of, Reliance has nicely bundled a 4GB microSD card with the tablet for your basic storage needs.

Open the rear panel and this is the smartphone-ish visual: the huge 3400 mAh battery, the SIM card slot and the microSD card slot.

We're impressed! That is to say the least. The initial apprehension that this'll perform like a low-cost tablet (and will essentially be a disappointment) evaporated very quickly. The 800MHz processor coupled with 512 MB of RAM helps Android 2.3.4 chug along quite nicely. While the interface does lag slightly, it is minimal. This is mostly felt when flicking through the multiple home screens or the application list. But the age-old problem with Android exists – open too many apps in the background and it will become sluggish.

The phone feature is back in the tablets—calls can be made and received, something that can't be done in most tablets of late.

Screen, battery

The seven-inch display of the Reliance 3G Tab is a humble TFT screen with a very basic 800x480 pixel resolution. While the display quality looks a little rough in general, there's enough sharpness to make text look crisp. Colours aren't very vivid, but enough for most usage scenarios. The touch screen responds well for the most part, but tends to suddenly go into a trance every once in a while – a minor annoyance.

The camera is a huge disappointment. The 2MP camera clicks pictures that can be called 'very grainy' at best. Battery life is surprisingly good on the Reliance 3G Tab.

With uninterrupted 3G usage, we had the device running for slightly more than two days – full charge to full discharge. During this time, there was



quite a bit of web browsing, the daily dose of Angry Birds, and it was even used as a Wi-Fi hotspot for a few hours. We have to admit the tablet's huge 3400mAh battery does the job admirably well.

Conclusion

The most interesting thing about the Reliance 3G Tab is the price, undoubtedly. What this does is lower the entry price barrier for branded tablets. We were pretty impressed by the performance in general.

While it isn't a multimedia or gaming powerhouse, the 3G Tab does a little bit of this and a little bit of that – steady performance, good battery life and a surprisingly sleek form factor. You do sacrifice on certain things – touch response that is slightly iffy at times and a bad camera. Remember, the critical point is the "at this price" factor. If the ₹30,000 plus Android tablets are out of your budget, this may just be the one to introduce you to the world of tablets.

Visbal Mathur

Specifications

Platform: Android 2.3.4;
Processor: ARM11 800MHz;
RAM: 512MB; **Display:** 7-inch TFT LCD, 800x480 pixel resolution; **Memory:** microSD card slot up to 32GB; **Battery:** 3400 mAh

Contact

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7.5
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Features 7.5
Performance..... 7.5
Build Quality 6.5
Value for Money 8.0